

E-Government Literacy (HCI Subcomponent)



E-Government Literacy

Indicator	Description
1.#003 Search feature	Government portal(s) can be found on the first results page of any search engine typically used in that country
2. #006 Help feature/FAQs section	A Help or 'Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)' feature available on the portal.
3.#007 Social networking features	The provision of social networking feature(s) (e.g. Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Flickr, etc.).
4. #009 Live chat support with a person	The provision of "live chat" support functionality with government employees/officers in real time.
5. #014 Privacy policy	Existence of a privacy policy or statement available on the MGP
6. #016 Information on online services use	Guidance or tutorials to people in understanding and using online services.
7. #017 Digital ID to access online services	Any kind of authentication required to access online services or restricted-access areas (e.g., digital ID; login and password; mobile key)



E-Government Literacy

Indicator	Description
8. #036a Facilitation of free Internet access	Information on connecting to the country's free WIFI or statements of agreement with mobile operators
9. #036b Access to physical spaces	Information on government access to physical spaces for online services
10. #038 Open data metadata	The provision of relevant metadata/ dictionary about each open data file.
11. #039 Guidance on using Open Government datasets	Evidence of guidance/toolkit on using Open Government datasets, helping users to better understand how to access and use open dataset
12. #086 Mark favorite/most used online services	Ability to customize/personalize the national portal(s) to mark users' favourite/most used online services
13. #317,318,319,320,321,322 Co Creation/production of e-services	Evidence of any co creation and/or co-production of e-service (for HEALTH/ EDUCATION/ EMPLOYMENT/ SOCIAL PROTECTION/ ENVIRONMENT/ JUSTICE)

1. Search feature (#003)

What	Qualified by a search bar on the main web page of the government portal and verified through a search using one word.
Why	Enables visitors to quickly and efficiently find specific information, services, or resources, enhancing user experience, promoting accessibility, and increasing overall user satisfaction and engagement.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Choose a Search Engine: a. Select a reliable search engine service or software that fits your budget and technical requirements. Google Custom Search, Algolia, and Elasticsearch are popular options. 2. Index Website Content: a. Ensure pages, documents, and resources on the government portal are indexed by the search engine. 3. Design User-Friendly Interface: a. Place the search bar prominently on the homepage and all other key pages. 4. Faceted Search (Filters): a. Implement filters that allow users to refine search results based on categories such as departments, document types, or publication dates. 5. Regularly Update Content: a. Keep the website content up-to-date. For more information check out Lynton's guide or Fresh Tech Tips.
Case Examples	Check out Ghana's portal search feature





2. Help feature/FAQs section (#006)

What	Defined by a Help or 'Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)' feature available on the portal. This feature is intended to help the user navigate the site and finding information and/or providing the user with an extensive knowledge base of commonly asked questions that users pose in their search for information.
Why	Provides instant, accurate, and accessible information, enhancing user experience, and promoting efficient communication between the government and people.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Identify Common Queries: a. Analyze frequently asked questions and common issues users encounter while using the portal. 2. User-Friendly Interface: a. Design a clean and intuitive interface with a dedicated section for FAQs. 3. Search Functionality: a. Implement a robust search bar allowing users to enter keywords and find relevant FAQs quickly. 4. Regular Updates: a. Keep the FAQs updated based on new queries and changing policies. Remove outdated information. 5. Prominent Placement: a. Feature the FAQs prominently on the portal, making it easily accessible from the homepage and main navigation menu. For more information check out WebFx's guide on Help Features or Zendesk's guide for FAQs.
Case Examples	Check out Fiji's extensive FAQ section organized by theme





3. Social networking features (#007)

What	The provision of social networking feature(s) (e.g. Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Flickr, etc.) on the portal.
Why	Fosters direct and interactive communication with users, enhances transparency, and encourages national engagement, creating a dynamic platform for sharing information and gathering public input.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Develop a Social Media Policy: a. Create clear guidelines for the use of social networking platforms. Define the purpose, responsible personnel, content guidelines, and response protocols. 2. Integrate Platforms Seamlessly: a. Work with web developers to seamlessly integrate social media buttons and feeds into your website. 3. Create Engaging Content: a. Develop a content strategy, share updates about country-wide events, public services, policies, achievements. 4. Regular Updates and Maintenance: a. Ensure regular updates on social media platforms to keep people informed. 5. Promote Civic Initiatives: a. Utilize social media to promote civic initiatives, events, and public awareness campaigns. 6. Monitor and Analyze: a. Utilize analytics tools provided by social media platforms to assess engagement, reach, and impact. Check out Sprout social's guide or Verbit's
Case Examples	Check out Morocco's social networks' page





4. Live chat support with a person (#009)

What	The provision of "live chat" support functionality with government employees/officers in real time . This covers real-time interaction through a person via different channels "click to chat", webchat, WeChat, WhatsApp, text messaging, and other live support functions.
Why	Provides real-time assistance, enhances citizen engagement, and fosters transparent communication between residents and government employees/officers, improving overall public service accessibility and satisfaction.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Choose a Suitable Platform: a. Select a reliable live chat software that supports various channels (i.e. "click to chat," webchat, WeChat, WhatsApp, and text messaging. 2. Employee Training for handling real-time interactions effectively and professionally. 3. Integration: a. Seamlessly integrate the chosen live chat software into the government website. 4. User-Friendly Design: a. Design an intuitive interface with clickable icons or buttons, making it easy for users to initiate chats. 5. Monitoring and Improvement: a. Implement a monitoring system to track response times, review chat transcripts, and gather user feedback. Use this data to continuously enhance service quality and employee training. Check out dacast's guide or touchpoint
Case Examples	Check out Iceland's live chat support available during specific hours



What	A formal statement, often found in the footer or home page either explicitly stated or in a related link, explains how the website collects, processes, stores, & protects the personal information of its users.
Why	Essential for establishing trust with users, ensuring compliance with relevant privacy laws and regulations, and demonstrating the government’s commitment to protecting individuals’ privacy
How?	Indicative Steps: 1. Clear Language: - Write the policy in simple, understandable language. - Specify what user information is collected & detail methods: cookies, forms, or third-party. 3. Processing & Storage: - Explain how collected data will be used. 4. Security Measures: - Describe data protection measures in place. 5. User Rights: - Outline user rights regarding their data and Include opt-out and data deletion options. 6. Legal Compliance: - Highlight adherence to data protection laws. Check out wikiHow’s on How to Create a Website Privacy Policy or The U.S. General Services Administration section on Privacy and identity management
Case Examples 	Check out Norway’s page on privacy policy



6. Information on online services use (#016)

What	Defined by evidence that the portal offers guidance or tutorials to people in understanding and using online services, e.g. Help-Link. These can also come under the form of training manuals and/or tutorials aimed at helping users to better understand how to access and use online services.
Why	Empowers people by providing clear instructions, fostering digital literacy, and ensuring that all residents can confidently access and utilize online services effectively.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Assess User Needs: a. Identify common challenges users face while navigating the government website. 2. Develop Clear Content: a. Create easy-to-understand tutorials 3. Implement Help-Link Section: a. Integrate a dedicated Help section on the website. 4. Regular Updates: a. Keep the content up-to-date, and review tutorials with changing services, common user queries. 5. Multimedia Support: a. Enhance tutorials with multimedia elements like videos and infographics. 6. Regular Analytics Review: a. Analyze user engagement data. Identify popular topics and areas where users struggle.
Case Examples	Check out <u>The United Arab Emirates'</u> tutorial for e-services.





7. Digital ID to access online services(#017)

What	Also referred to as "e-ID" in some countries, it can be used through secure login methods, such as usernames, passwords, or multi-factor authentication to offer personalized online/mobile services to the user. Portal authentication ensures that the user's identity has to be verified when getting online.
Why	It ensures that individuals interacting with the portal are genuine and authorized, safeguards sensitive government data and services, enhancing online security and user trust.
How?	Indicative Steps 1. Identify Security Needs: - Determine the level of security required for the website 2. Choose Authentication Methods: - Select appropriate authentication methods, such as username/password, biometrics, or multi-factor authentication (MFA). 3. Develop User Database: - Create a secure database to store user credentials. 4. Integrate Authentication System: - Integrate the chosen authentication methods into the website's login process 5. Regular Security Audits: - Conduct regular security audits and updates to identify and address potential vulnerabilities Check out UK's National Cyber Security Center Guide or OWASP's Authentication Cheat Sheet
Case Examples 	Check out Australia's myGov Digital ID



8. Facilitation of free Internet access (#036a)

What	Evidence of government provision of free access to the Internet i.e. free WIFI in specific areas or agreement with mobile operators.
Why	Vital for promoting digital inclusion, bridging the digital divide, and ensuring equal access to essential online services and information for all residents.
How?	Indicative steps: Dedicated Webpage: - Create a user-friendly webpage detailing free Internet access locations and instructions. Clear Information: - Provide concise details on how to connect Promotion: - Actively promote the initiative through social media, events, and businesses. Updates and Feedback: - Regularly update the webpage and provide a feedback mechanism for user suggestions and issues.
Case Examples	Check out Uruguay's free internet access page



Submit your case [here](#)



9. Access to physical spaces for online services (#036b)

What	Information on the government portal of government provision of physical spaces i.e. community centers, post offices, libraries and personal assistance to access online services in these locations.
Why	Crucial for ensuring inclusive and equitable access to government services, fostering digital literacy, and enhancing engagement.
How?	Indicative steps: Partnership: - Collaborate with community centers, post offices, and libraries to integrate online services. Infrastructure: - Provide necessary technology and internet access at these locations. Training: - Train staff to assist residents in accessing online services effectively. Awareness: - Promote the availability of services through social media and the government portal. Feedback: - Establish a feedback system for continuous improvement and resident satisfaction.
Case Examples	Check out Singapore's page on Multimedia Stations





10. Open data metadata (#038)

What	The provision of relevant metadata, such as description, date, author, and other relevant information about each open data file by the government website.
Why	Enhances data transparency, facilitates accurate understanding and usage, and allows users to assess the data's relevance and reliability, promoting informed decision-making and fostering trust in the government
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Standardize Metadata Fields: a. Establish a standardized format for metadata fields to maintain consistency across all datasets. 2. Detailed Descriptions: a. Encourage authors to provide in-depth descriptions of the dataset 3. Accurate Date and Versioning: a. Always include the date of dataset creation or the last update. 4. Author Information: a. Include the name, contact details, and affiliation of the individual or department for the dataset. 5. Relevant Tags and Categories: a. Assign appropriate tags and categories to each dataset. 6. Data Format and Size: a. Specify the file format (e.g., CSV, JSON, Excel) and size of the dataset. Check out Ireland's Open Data Portal Guide or Center for Gov
Case Examples 	Check out Costa Rica's open data portal including extensive metadata



11. Guidance on Open Government datasets (#039)

What	Evidence of guidance or toolkit on using Open Government datasets, e.g. training manuals and/or tutorials aimed at helping users to better understand how to access and use open datasets. Open data means that the data can be readily and easily consulted and reused by anyone. Open data must fulfill the following conditions: 1) Machine-readable, 2) No legal barriers to access the data, 3) Free of charge, and 4) Available in widespread type of files or in open standards.
Why	Crucial to empower users with the knowledge and tools needed to access and utilize data effectively, fostering transparency, innovation, and informed decision-making.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Training Materials: a. Develop comprehensive manuals or tutorials for accessing open datasets. 2. User-Friendly Tools: a. Ensure clear, easy-to-use guidance tools on the portal. 3. Interactive Workshops: a. Host webinars or workshops to educate users about open data. 4. Clear Instructions: a. Provide straightforward directions for navigating and downloading datasets. 5. Feedback Channels: a. Establish easy ways for users to provide input and ask questions.
Case Examples	Check out Singapore's user guide for open data sets





12. Mark favorite/most used online services (#086)

What	The ability for users to customize/personalize the national portal(s) to mark their favourite/most used online services through any of the government portal(s)
Why	Enhances user engagement and satisfaction, promoting a more user-centric approach to digital governance.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Establish User Account System: a. Develop a system that allows users to create accounts to personalize their portal experience. 2. Implement Bookmarking Feature: a. Incorporate a feature that enables users to bookmark or mark their favorite or frequently used online services. 3. Provide Customization Instructions: a. Offer clear and concise instructions on how users can customize and personalize their portal settings. 4. Ensure Cross-Portal Accessibility: a. Ensure that the customization features are accessible across all government portals for seamless user experience.
Case Examples	Check out Finland's feature to mark your favorite online services





13. Co-creation of e-services (#317,318,319,320,321,322)

What	Evidence of any co-creation and/or co-production (with people) of e-service on the following sectors: HEALTH/ EDUCATION/ EMPLOYMENT/ SOCIAL PROTECTION/ ENVIRONMENT/ JUSTICE). Instances where people actively collaborated with government entities in the development or enhancement of online services in above sectors.
Why	Underscores the importance of fostering citizen-government partnerships to ensure the relevance and effectiveness of e-services
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Develop User-Friendly Online Platforms: a. Create accessible digital spaces for citizen engagement in service development. 2. Encourage Active Participation: a. Facilitate involvement through surveys, feedback forms, and interactive forums. 3. Collaborate with National Organizations: a. Partner with national groups to engage diverse segments of the population. 4. Ensure Transparency in the Co-Creation Process: a. Publicly document the collaborative efforts and outcomes of service development.
Case Examples	Check out the United Arab Emirates ' co creation on e-services

